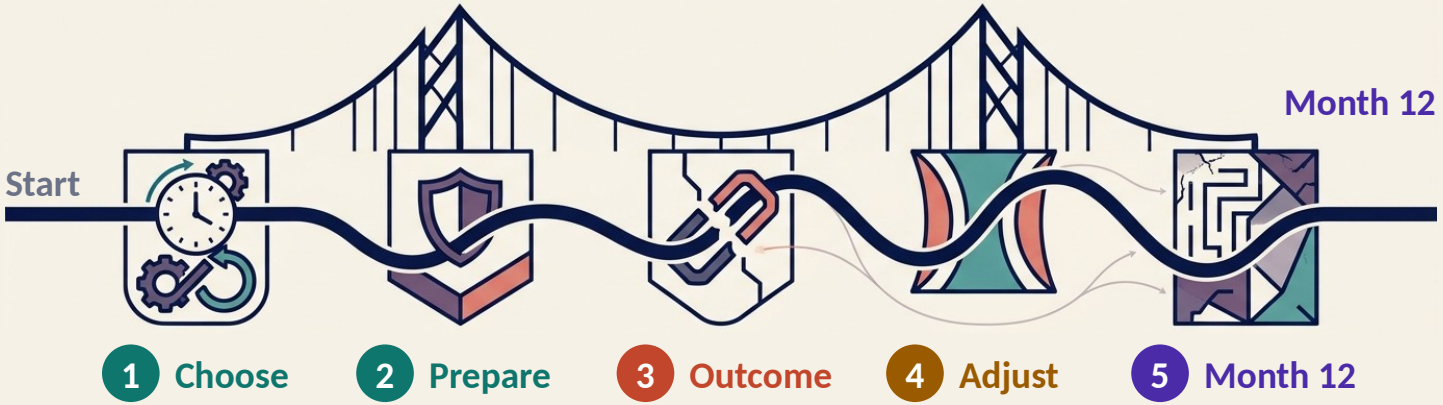
Groww GROWTH TEAM · SIP CONTINUATION CASE STUDY

Keeping a first SIP workable when cash flow changes

Problem hypothesis. First-time investors often start with good intent, but when the debit date and the money available stop lining up, and the way back after an interruption is unclear, a first SIP can lapse without a real decision to stop.

Research-backed hypothesis · not a universal explanation



The first-SIP year: the investor chooses a debit date, prepares for each debit, the instalment succeeds or doesn't, and then they adjust, recover or stop (slide 2).

NORTH STAR · BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

Month-12 first-SIP continuation

$$\frac{\text{Eligible cohort investors with ≥ 1 successful SIP instalment in the 30 days ending at month 12}}{\text{All eligible first-time MF investors who started their first SIP in that cohort}} \times 100$$

Active SIP = at least one successful instalment in the preceding 30 days.
Goal raise this share for first-time investors.

THE CASE IN ONE READ

Investigated 19,005 public records (450 coded), 5 interviews, a 20-person survey.

Decided the problem is broader than failed payments: cash-flow fit and clarity of options.

Built a contextual SIP Companion on illustrative data; actions are simulated.

Not yet proven usefulness (one participant's feedback) and any effect on month-12 continuation.

Optional: SIP Companion nl-groww-sip.vercel.app/companion · Discovery Engine nl-groww-engine.vercel.app · not affiliated with Groww

Groww

Four moments in year one decide month-12 continuation

1 Start and choose



Picks amount and debit date; sets up the autopay mandate.

LEADING INDICATOR

Mandate live before debit 1 (% of new first SIPs)

EVIDENCE (denominator)

Survey: 10 of 20 starters matched the date to payday

2 Prepare for the debit



Money has to be in the account on the debit day.

LEADING INDICATOR

Upcoming-debit details viewed ÷ scheduled debits

EVIDENCE (denominator)

Interviews: 4 of 5 timed the debit to income or checked balance

3 Instalment outcome



Succeeds, fails as an auto-debit, or is missed on purpose. Counted separately.

LEADING INDICATOR

First-try success, instalments 1–3; failures and skips split

EVIDENCE (denominator)

Public: 52 of 352 lapse stories

Survey: 4 of 20 had a failure

Interviews: 2 of 5 failure; 1 skipped

4 Recover, adjust or stop



Pay the missed one, skip, lower, move the date, pause or stop. Stopping is not redeeming units.

LEADING INDICATOR

Failed instalment resolved before the next debit; skip → resumed within 60 days

EVIDENCE (denominator)

Survey: 9 of 20 skipped or paused on purpose; 8 restarted

Survey: of the 4 failures, 3 waited, 1 paused, 0 paid

5 NORTH STAR

Active at month 12

Cohort investors with ≥ 1 successful instalment in the 30 days ending at month 12 ÷ all eligible first-time starters in the cohort × 100

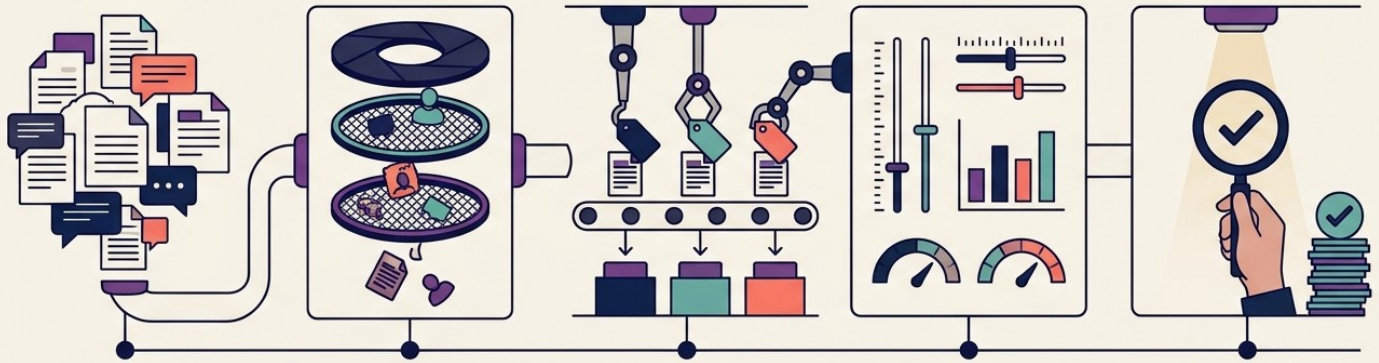
Points 1–4 are diagnostics, not the North Star. They are proposed Groww metrics: none has been measured in this study. **Guardrails:** pressure complaints, pay-after-stop

Kept apart | **A missed instalment is not churn, and stopping is not redeeming units.** Failed debit, intentional miss, skip, pause and stop are tracked separately.

Evidence is measured; indicators are proposed. Public = 352 lapse-labelled coded posts · survey = 20 starters (convenience) · 5 interviews

Groww

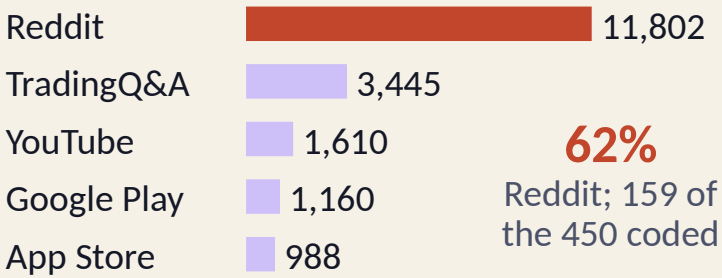
From 19,005 public records to 450 coded SIP experiences



19,005 Collect — 5 platforms
2,518 Filter — 2 keyword gates
450 AI code — codebook v1.2
8 Score — drivers ranked
60 Human check — 3 rounds of 20

The 450: 352 lapse · 50 continuer · 48 context. **409** labelled first-hand by the AI, not checked by a human. **390** labels are AI-only.

Collected by platform (n = 19,005)



62%
Reddit; 159 of the 450 coded

Human vs AI label agreement

Round	Codebook	Agree	κ
1	v1.0	4/20	0.15
2	v1.1	7/20	0.29
3	**v1.2**	**11/20**	**0.50**

Moderate, preliminary (n = 20 each)

So: the engine is used to find and rank mechanisms worth testing, never to size the problem.
Next: what the 352 lapse stories say.

Read before using any number

This dataset identifies and prioritises reported lapse mechanisms; it does not estimate SIP lapse prevalence among all investors.

Selection not reproducible. How 450 were picked from 2,518 was not documented.

Rejects not kept. 16,487 records failed the filters and 2,068 passed but were not coded; neither set or its reasons was retained.

352/450 is not a lapse rate. The gates targeted SIP problems, so 78% of the coded set is lapse-labelled by design.

Thin human check. 60 records checked; 38 disagreed, 29 reconciled by one reviewer, 0 independently adjudicated.

Skewed sources. Public posts lean negative, and Reddit dominates.

Research Assistant: live AI on since 6 Nov; one smoke test was grounded. Not yet evaluated live.

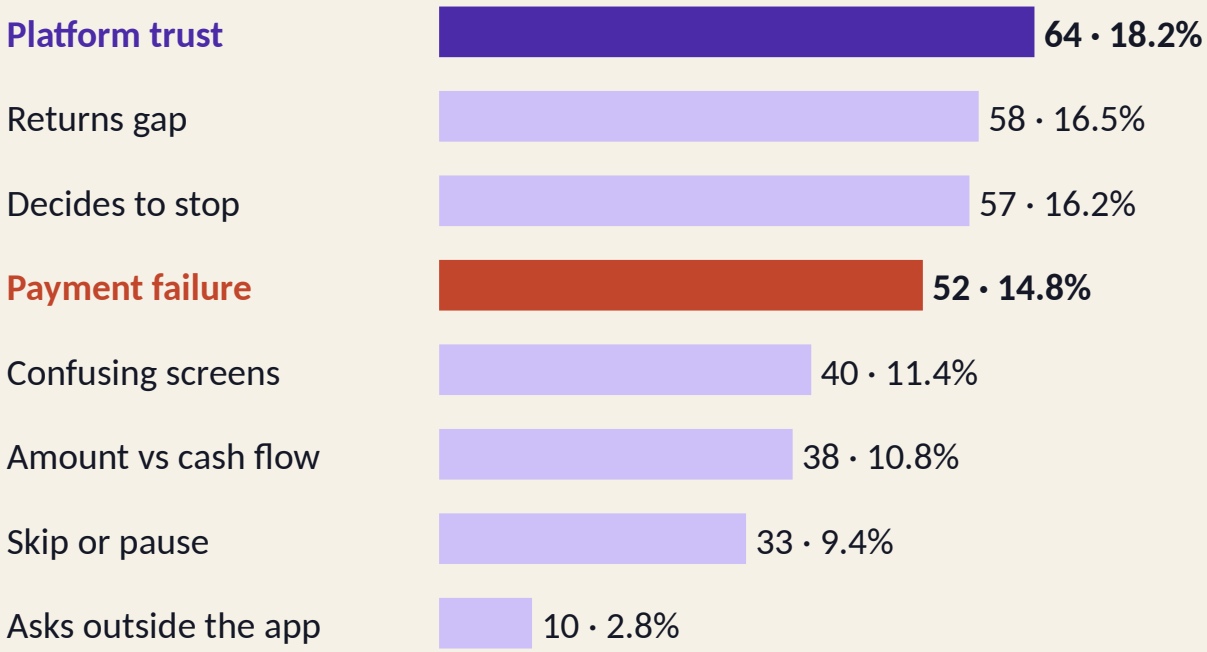
Groww

Trust is discussed most; payment failure is close behind



Lapse-labelled stories by primary driver

Count and share of the 352 lapse-labelled coded records; one primary driver each, so counts add to 352.



Tie rule: when several drivers apply, the label goes to the one closest to an exit (payment first). This favours the payment-failure count.

In investors' words (public posts)

> "SIP … rejected after 7-8 days … 4 different mutual funds … will not use groww anymore"
> **Payment failure** · A27 · App Store

> "5 SIPs … insufficient balance … Missing SIPs are fine but the mandate shouldn't fail"
> **Amount vs cash flow** · R40 · Reddit

> "skip 1 installment or cancel completely but I just want to pause for a few months"
> **Skip or pause** · P18 · Google Play

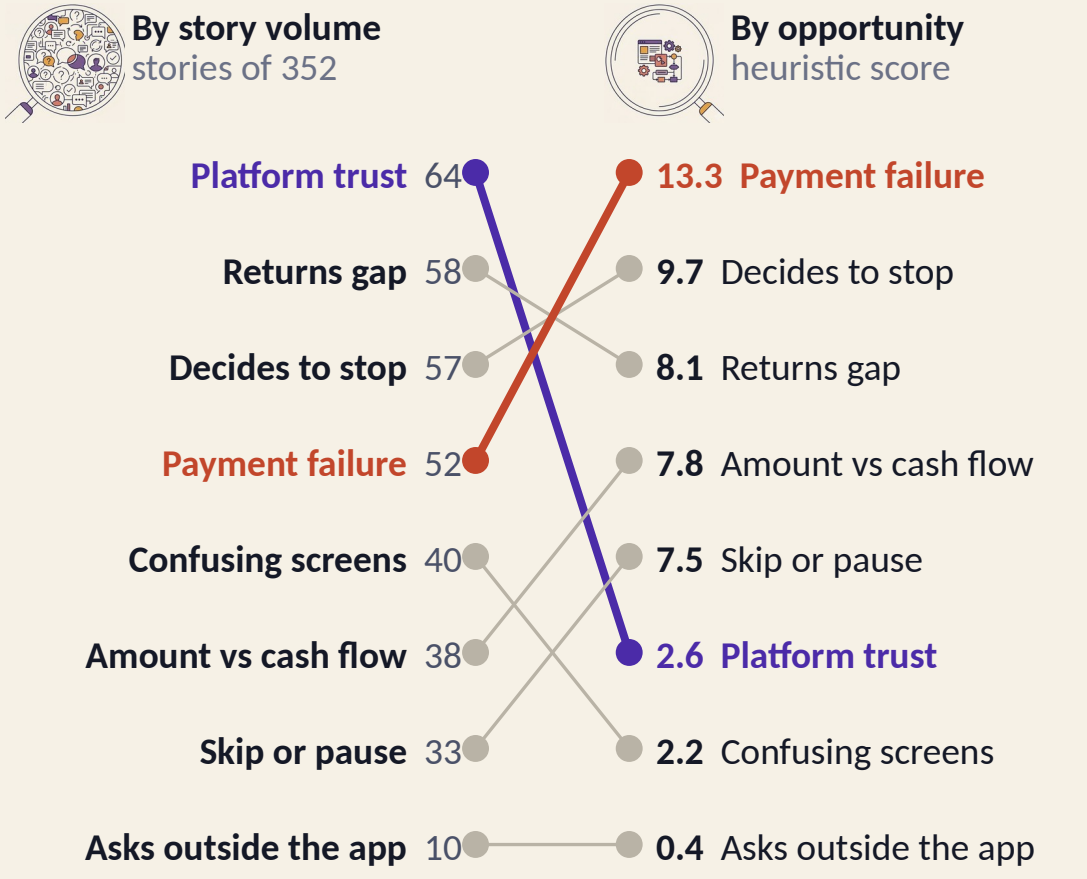
> "serious discrepancy in my mutual fund holdings between Groww and CAMS"
> **Platform trust** · A19 · App Store

Sample only | Shares describe this coded sample, not the causes of lapse among all investors. Volume alone doesn't show where a product can help, so slide 5 scores each driver.

Source: Discovery Engine dataset, codebook v1.2 · every record ID opens in the Evidence Explorer

Groww

Payment failure ranks first on addressability, not volume



#1 by volume → #6 by opportunity (trust) · **#4 → #1** (payment failure)

Why the order flips

	Payment failure	Platform trust	Decides to stop
Stories (of 352)	52 · 14.8%	64 · 18.2%	57 · 16.2%
Exit relevance*	1.0	0.5	1.0
Addressability*	0.9	0.3	0.6
Evidence quality	1.00	0.97	1.00
Score	**13.3**	**2.6**	**9.7**

Payment failure: 3 failed instalments in a row cancel a monthly SIP, and status, reason and retry live in the app.

Platform trust: allotment and registrar delays rarely end a SIP alone, and sit mostly in operations.

Robust to noise, not to the weights. Payment failure stays first in **945 of 1,000** resamples of the 352 stories and **937 of 1,000** random ±0.15 weight nudges. Without the analyst weights it ranks 4th.

Heuristic only

*Analyst-set weights: a ranking of where to look, not retention impact, lift, ROI or probability. However, interviews then challenged this ranking (slides 6–7).

Recomputed from the 450 records on every build: 0 of 8 mismatches · Opportunity Ranking with full calculation · AMFI SIP cancellation FAQ

Groww

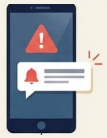
Interviewees plan around cash flow; few hit failed debits



Proactive planning
keep debits on track by hand



Adapting to cash flow
move the date or miss on purpose



Recovery
after failed debits

P01
Not on Groww

Checks the bank balance before each auto-debit

No failure

P02
Zerodha Coin

Debit on the 1st, after salary arrives

No failure

P04
Not on Groww

Moved the date when a new job changed payday

Debit error

P05
Platform unclear

Skipped on purpose when money was short

Not a failure

P03
On Groww

Two low-balance failures; later stopped the SIP

Failed ×2

Unresolved: P03's stated debit date (4th) doesn't match the recorded failure dates; P04's error details and P05's platform are unconfirmed.

Survey · separate convenience sample, n = 20 starters, mixed platforms (8 on Groww) · form

4 of 20
starters had a failed instalment: 3 waited, 1 paused, 0 paid

10 of 20
starters matched the SIP date to payday

9 of 20
starters skipped or paused on purpose; 8 restarted

What this means: in these interviews, managing cash timing was more common than recovering from failures. Five people, mostly not on Groww: direction, not proof.

Interviewees, out of 5, who…

	1	2	3	4	5	
Debit timing or balance	●	●	●	●	○	4/5
Money limits the SIP	○	●	●	●	●	4/5
Looked outside the app	●	●	●	●	○	4/5
Failed debit or error	○	○	●	●	○	2/5
Missed on purpose	○	○	○	○	●	1/5
First SIP on Groww	○	○	●	○	◌	1/5
SIP still active	●	●	○	●	●	4/5

Filled = yes · dashed = unresolved

TARGET SEGMENT (PROVISIONAL)
First-year, first-time SIP investors whose cash flow makes scheduled instalments hard to keep. Exploratory; only 1/5 confirmed Groww first-SIP.

Interview workbook P01–P05 (Oct 2026) with corrections of 5 Nov · survey Oct 2026 · counts never combined

Groww

Interviews widened the problem beyond failed payments

1 · The engine said
Payment failure ranked first of 8 drivers on opportunity score (13.3).

Heuristic

→

2 · Interviews challenged it
Only 2 of 5 interviewees had a failed debit or error; 4 of 5 planned their SIP around when cash arrives.

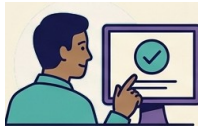
Observed

→

3 · So the problem was reframed
Beyond failed-debit recovery: help investors understand interruptions and their options. Hence an explaining Companion.

Hypothesis

Four ways continuation breaks, from the evidence



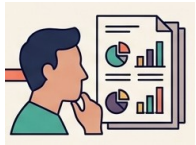
A · Cash arrives after the debit date
P04 moved the date when a new job changed payday; P05's pocket money came late. 10 of 20 survey starters align the date to payday.



B · Balance short, the auto-debit fails
P03: two low-balance failures, unsure how many misses cancel a SIP. 52 of 352 public lapse stories; 4 of 20 survey starters, none paid.



C · A contribution is missed on purpose
P05 skipped when money was short and assumed the SIP carried on. 9 of 20 survey starters skipped or paused; 8 restarted.



D · Wants to stop, unsure of the consequences
P03 stopped when they needed money and asked Reddit, YouTube and peers. 57 of 352 public lapse stories.

ROOT PROBLEM (RESEARCH-BACKED HYPOTHESIS)
Scheduled SIP commitments and changing cash availability can drift apart, and the path to understanding and recovering from an interruption is unclear.

Moment The instalment around a cash shortfall, months 1–12

Outcome Interruptions understood and chosen, not drifted into

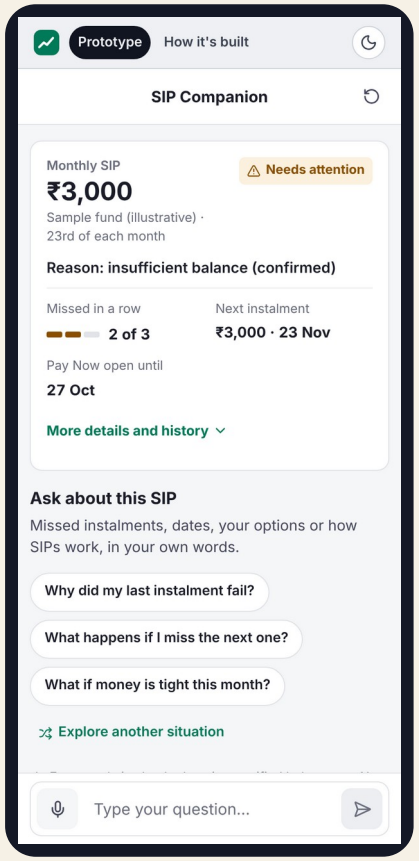
Workarounds Balance checks, payday dates, family, friends, Reddit, YouTube

Value Users decide with their own facts; Groww keeps more SIPs active (to be tested)

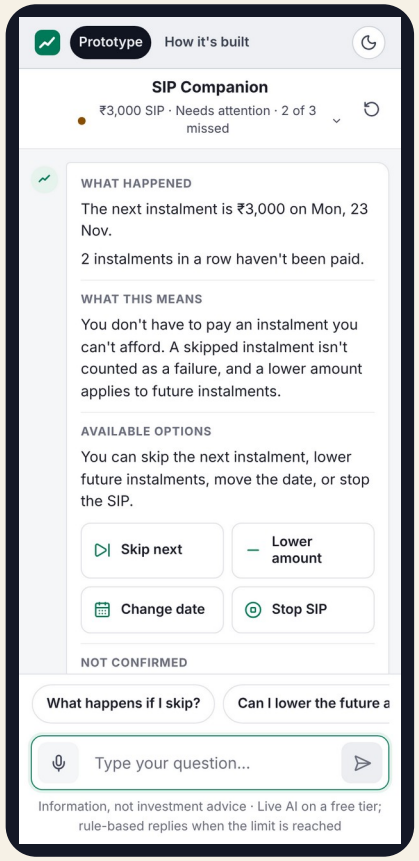
Policy: AMFI uniform SIP cancellation · Groww Help: cancelling a SIP · interviews n = 5, survey n = 20, public = 352 lapse-labelled records

Groww

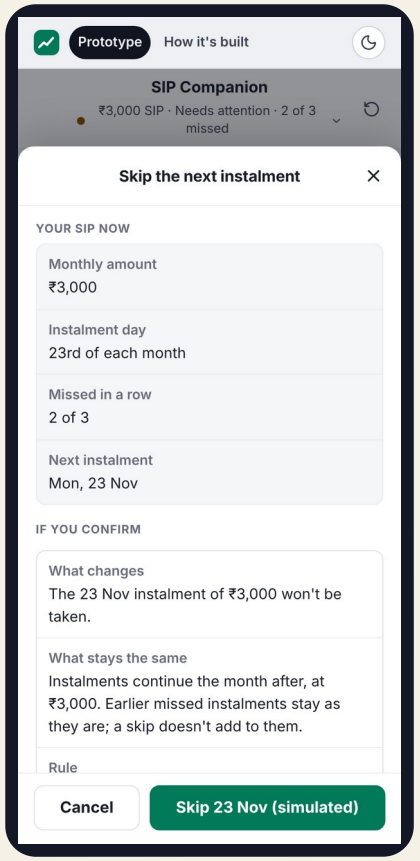
Companion explains your situation, then your options



1 Sees their SIP



2 Asks a question



3 Reviews a skip

Mobile layout shown; desktop uses a two-column layout with the same features.
Independent case-study prototype · not a Groww product.

What the investor sees, and why it matters

1. **Their own SIP first.** 2 of 3 missed in a row and the confirmed reason, before any question. **Boundary:** Shows status; never pushes Pay.

2. **An answer about this SIP.** In sections: what happened, what it means, options. Applies the 3-in-a-row rule and Pay Now window to its own dates. A FAQ can't. **Boundary:** No fund advice.

3. **A review before any change.** Shows the SIP now, what changes and what stays. Confirming changes the demo only. **Boundary:** Simulated: no money moves.

How a reply is produced

1 · App code	decides which options exist
2 · Reviewed facts	22 facts from 13 Groww, AMFI, SEBI pages
3 · AI model	drafts the reply in plain words, when live
4 · 15 checks	block invented facts, advice, pressure
5 · Shown, or fallback	a labelled rule-based reply if AI fails

Screenshots: build 23cf859 run locally, scenario A, rule-based mode (not live AI) · production (live AI): SIP Companion

Groww

Live AI deployed; factual validation still has a gap

AI ANSWERS

23/25 was 22/25 on frozen build 201ceaa

Machine-scored post-fix regression: same 25 inspected cases, build 231973d, 6 Nov



Live AI + fallback

Still failing: H021 tax and H025 secret request (fallback replies); fixes not deployed

FACTUAL CLAIMS

57/58

claims correct when checked by hand (5 Nov)



By hand

The 1 error, "pay before cancelling", is blocked only in its original wording

SAFETY

16/16

unsafe AI drafts blocked in red-team tests



Rule-based

Plus 24/24 multi-turn replies passed

USER FEEDBACK

"It provides contextual explanations, clarifies available options, and helps users make informed decisions."

P05 · one participant, qualitative

Human review found an error the checks passed

18/18 live answers passed the automated checks; human review then found H016, scored as a pass in 23/25, falsely said the next instalment must be paid before cancelling (next debit 28 days away). The check misses this passive wording. **Separately,** H019 used mildly directive "ensure ₹3,000 is available" wording.

How far this evidence goes

Tested AI safety and accuracy, on small, partly inspected sets

Early signal usefulness: one person's feedback; no task tests yet

Not yet shown month-12 impact; cancellation answers not fully validated

Engine assistant: live since 6 Nov, 1 grounded smoke test, **not an evaluation** · deterministic only: 26/26 dev (tuned), 7/10 held-out

Companion v3.2 report and claim audit (5 Nov) · post-fix regression (6 Nov) · Engine 2.1 report · Companion · Engine AI Quality

Groww

Guardrails keep it explanatory: no fund picks, no pressure

Eight risks, and the guardrail already in the MVP

1 Wrong facts · open
H016 passive cancel claim passes checks; recheck facts at launch

2 AI quota, downtime
Groq free-tier limits; labelled rule-based fallback, same checks

3 Advice and safety
Declines fund picks; tax and secret-request fixes not deployed

4 Wrong options
Code decides which actions are eligible; review before confirm

5 Pressure to pay
No urgency; Pay never default; Stop as easy

6 Unevaluated live AI
Live in both apps; engine: 1 smoke test; Gemini routes untested

7 Biased research
Reddit-heavy; validate with Groww cohort data

8 Real transactions
Simulated: no money moves, no Groww account; blocks PAN, OTP

What comes next: close validation gaps, then prove value

1 Fix cancellation semantic check → 2 Evaluate engine live AI → 3 Test Gemini routes → 4 Collect real feedback → 5 Groww first-SIP user tests → 6 Retention experiment

Roadmap: built: miss-count card, Companion · next: pre-debit readiness, payday-aware date · later: pause with a return date

Open validation requirement: every AI statement about whether an action is allowed, and when, must be checked against code-computed eligibility by meaning, not by text patterns.

Help investors understand their SIP situation and available options, without pressure or investment recommendations.